

Chapter 68 Part 4

Sheng Linlang hadn't socialized or attended business functions for a long time. At home, she had nothing to do but copy Buddhist scriptures and read books. Occasionally she'd go out shopping to buy things for her husband and daughters, not concerning herself with worldly affairs.

Even when the company was on the verge of bankruptcy, her heart remained unperturbed. She felt that at worst they could just live a hard life.

After her parents and younger brother passed away, she began cultivating her body and mind.

Especially since her eldest daughter had been kidnapped when she was young, and afterward fell ill every few days—fate didn't seem to be very kind to her.

After Xu Guangyao and the others left, Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu went to the place Sheng Linlang had mentioned.

It was also in the direction Yang Jiani had left.

When they arrived, there were fresh flowers placed in front of the two elders' tombstone.

It seemed Yang Jiani had indeed come to pay respects to her parents, but... it wasn't a holiday, wasn't New Year's, and wasn't their death anniversary either. Why would she suddenly come?

Liang Shi felt something wasn't quite right, so she walked around the area and discovered that another tombstone in the same row, separated by four graves, also had fresh flowers in front of it.

But this tombstone was rather special—it was an unmarked grave.

The flowers were baby's breath¹, purple and yellow baby's breath that looked especially clean and pure after being washed by the rain.

"An unmarked grave." Liang Shi guessed in a low voice, "Did Yang Jiani place these?"

Xu Qingzhu shook her head. "Not sure."

But she felt it was very likely.

Given Yang Jiani's pathological obsession with Qi Jiao, if Qi Jiao had died, she couldn't possibly not bury her.

But there was still a Qi Jiao alive now, so it was also impossible to erect a tombstone. So there was a very high possibility she would set up an unmarked grave for her.

At the same time, burying her in the same cemetery as her parents, each time using the excuse of paying respects to her parents when she was actually paying respects to her daughter.

"So what special day is today?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu suddenly raised an eyebrow. "Perhaps we can ask Rainbow?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi felt this was a good idea.

So she stood there and called Zhou Li, then asked for Rainbow to take the call.

Liang Shi asked very tactfully, "Rainbow, do you know if today is some important day for Teacher Qi?"

Rainbow flipped through a calendar. "It's her birthday, the lunar calendar one."

Liang Shi felt this made everything clear. After exchanging pleasantries with Rainbow for a few sentences, she ended up being teased by Rainbow. "Sister Liang, you're so fake."

Liang Shi: "?"

"I'm just a tool person²." Rainbow said.

Liang Shi: "....."

For a little kid to have such a trendy self-awareness of her own positioning.

And what she said today wasn't even wrong. Liang Shi could only say helplessly, "I'll treat you to something delicious another day."

Rainbow haggled with her. "Can you bring just me alone?"

"Sure." Liang Shi agreed.

After hanging up, Liang Shi checked the date. It was the end of the eighth lunar month.

She made a note of the date, then bowed in front of the tombstone before preparing to leave with Xu Qingzhu.

But on their way out of the cemetery, they passed by a mother and daughter.

Having just seen what might be Qi Jiao's grave, Liang Shi was feeling down. The umbrella was held very low, and she was in no mood to look at her surroundings.

So it was just a simple passing by.

Footnotes

¹ *Baby's breath* - Known in Chinese as "满天星" (mǎntiānxīng), literally "stars filling the sky." These are small, delicate flowers (*Gypsophila*) commonly used as filler in bouquets. They symbolize everlasting love, purity, and innocence.

² *Tool person* - "工具人" (gōngjùrén) is a modern Chinese internet slang term referring to someone who is used by others only when needed for a specific purpose, like a tool, and is otherwise ignored or unvalued. It's similar to being used or taken advantage of.